

As I went down to the river to pray

Text: African American Spiritual

Music: African American Spiritual

AS I WENT DOWN TO THE RIVER TO PRAY irregular

The musical score is written for voice and piano. It features a treble and bass clef with a key signature of one sharp (F#). The time signature is irregular, changing from 2/2 to 3/2 and back to 2/2. The melody is primarily in the treble clef, with piano accompaniment in the bass clef. Chord symbols (G, D, C) are placed above the staff to indicate harmonic structure. The lyrics are written below the staff, with some words hyphenated across lines. The score concludes with a 'Fine' marking and a 'D.C.' (Da Capo) instruction.

As I went down to the riv-er to pray, stud-y-in' a-bout that good old way,
and who shall wear the star - ry crown, good Lord, show me the way.
1 Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, let's go down, come on down.
Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, down to the riv-er to pray.

2. Oh, brothers, ...

3. Oh, children, ...

4. Oh, sinners, ...